

Drunken tempeh by the sea

Have you ever imagined a vegetarian surf and turf? Well, here it is in concept, anyway—an all-in-one meal, **perfect** for a fall or winter evening. Serve with a side of crunchy green salad. This casserole features hijiki, a mild type of dried dark brown or black seaweed also known as sea vegetable. The hijiki is reconstituted in water before use and is a nutritious addition to salads, soups, and stews.

About 1 ounce hijiki [30g]

1 medium onion, chopped

1½ tablespoons olive oil

½ yellow bell pepper, chopped

½ red bell pepper, chopped

3 garlic cloves, minced

1 teaspoon chili powder

½ teaspoon paprika

½ teaspoon cinnamon

1½ cups Guinness Extra Stout or other dark beer [375ml]

1 tablespoon hearty mustard, such as Dijon or country-style

1 tablespoon tomato paste

1 teaspoon tamarind paste

1 tablespoon vegetarian Worcestershire sauce

½ teaspoon salt

⅛ teaspoon freshly ground pepper

½ cup Bhutanese red rice [100g]

1 package (8 ounces) tempeh, cut into ½-inch [1-cm] cubes [250g]

1. **Preheat** the oven to 375°F [190°C]. Soak the hijiki in 1 cup [250ml] warm water until softened, about 15 minutes. Drain, reserving the soaking water.
2. In a large skillet, **cook** the onion in the olive oil over medium heat until softened and lightly browned, 5 to 7 minutes. Add the bell peppers and garlic and cook until softened, another 2 to 3 minutes. Add the chili powder, paprika, and cinnamon, and cook until fragrant, about 1 minute. Pour in the Guinness and ½ cup [125ml] of the reserved soaking water.

3. Bring to a boil. **Stir** in the mustard, tomato paste, tamarind paste, Worcestershire sauce, salt, and pepper. Cook and stir for 1 minute, then add the rice and tempeh and mix well. Pour into a 2-quart [2L] casserole dish.
4. Cover and **bake** for 35 to 40 minutes, or until the casserole is hot and bubbling, the rice is tender, and most of the liquid is absorbed.

SERVES 4

